50 MOST USED SPANISH VERBS

in the pretérito perfecto — part 1 of 2:

A1

THE WHOLE TENSE IN ONE RULE

haber + participio

Only **haber** changes. The participle is one frozen form — it never agrees with anybody and it never stem-changes, so *volver* gives **vuelto** but *encontrar* gives **encontrado**, not *encuentrado*.

CONJUGATE ONLY **HABER** — THEN ADD THE PARTICIPLE, UNCHANGED

yo	tú	él / ella	nosotros	vosotros	ellos	+ *participio*
he	**has**	**ha**	**hemos**	**habéis**	**han**	

-ar → -ado
hablar → hablado · jugar → jugado

-er · -ir → -ido
comer → comido · vivir → vivido

vowel + -ído
leer → leído · oír → oído

Nine verbs ignore all of this: **abierto · dicho · escrito · hecho · muerto · puesto · roto · visto · vuelto**. That is the complete list — everything else follows the three rules on the left.

Ser
to be

→ **sido**

Siempre ha sido así.
It has always been like this.

Estar
to be

→ **estado**

¿Has estado en España?
Have you been to Spain?

Tener
to have

→ **tenido**

He tenido un día largo.
I have had a long day.

Haber
there to be

→ **habido**

Ha habido un problema.
There has been a problem.

Hacer
to do / make

→ **hecho**
IRREGULAR

¿Qué has hecho hoy?
What have you done today?

Ir
to go

→ **ido**

He ido al médico.
I have been to the doctor.

Venir
to come

→ **venido**

No ha venido nadie.
Nobody has come.

Querer
to want

→ **querido**

Siempre he querido aprender.
I have always wanted to learn.

Poder
to be able to

→ **podido**

No he podido dormir.
I have not been able to sleep.

Saber
to know (facts)

→ **sabido**

Siempre lo he sabido.
I have always known it.

Conocer
to know (people)

→ **conocido**

He conocido a su hermana.
I have met his sister.

Gustar
to like

→ **gustado**

Me ha gustado mucho.
I liked it a lot.

Hablar
to speak

→ **hablado**

Hemos hablado con el jefe.
We have spoken to the boss.

Comer
to eat

→ **comido**

Hoy he comido en casa.
Today I have eaten at home.

Vivir
to live

→ **vivido**

He vivido aquí dos años.
I have lived here two years.

Trabajar
to work

→ **trabajado**

Esta semana hemos trabajado mucho.
We have worked a lot this week.

Necesitar
to need

→ **necesitado**

Nunca he necesitado ayuda.
I have never needed help.

Llevar
to carry / wear

→ **llevado**

¿Quién ha llevado las llaves?
Who has taken the keys?

Poner
to put

→ **puesto**
IRREGULAR

He puesto la mesa.
I have set the table.

Ver
to see

→ **visto**
IRREGULAR

¿Has visto esta película?
Have you seen this film?

Decir
to say

→ **dicho**
IRREGULAR

Me ha dicho que sí.
He has said yes to me.

Dar
to give

→ **dado**

El médico me ha dado una receta.
The doctor has given me a prescription.

Salir
to go out

→ **salido**

Ha salido en las noticias.
It has been on the news.

Dormir
to sleep

→ **dormido**

No he dormido bien.
I have not slept well.

Buscar
to look for

→ **buscado**

Te he buscado por todas partes.
I have looked for you everywhere.

Nothing may come between *haber* and the participle. *Ya he comido* or *he comido ya* — never *he ya comido*.
Pronouns go in front of *haber*, not after it: *me he levantado, lo he visto, no te he oído*.

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Encontrar
to find

→ **encontrado**

No he encontrado las gafas.

I have not found my glasses.

Perder
to lose

→ **perdido**

He perdido el tren.

I have missed the train.

Traer
to bring

→ **traído**

¿Has traído el libro?

Have you brought the book?

Beber
to drink

→ **bebido**

Solo he bebido agua.

I have only drunk water.

Tocar
to touch / play

→ **tocado**

Nunca he tocado la guitarra.

I have never played the guitar.

Volver
to come back

→ **vuelto**

IRREGULAR

Ha vuelto a casa.

He has come back home.

Empezar
to start

→ **empezado**

Ya hemos empezado.

We have already started.

Jugar
to play (games)

→ **jugado**

Hoy he jugado al pádel.

Today I have played padel.

Pensar
to think

→ **pensado**

Lo he pensado mucho.

I have thought about it a lot.

Pedir
to ask for / order

→ **pedido**

Hemos pedido la cuenta.

We have asked for the bill.

Correr
to run

→ **corrido**

He corrido diez kilómetros.

I have run ten kilometres.

Nadar
to swim

→ **nadado**

Esta mañana he nadado.

I have swum this morning.

Llamar
to call

→ **llamado**

Mis padres han llamado dos veces.

My parents have called twice.

Llegar
to arrive

→ **llegado**

Esta mañana hemos llegado tarde.

We arrived late this morning.

Mirar
to look at

→ **mirado**

Lo he mirado en internet.

I have looked it up online.

Creer
to believe

→ **creído**

Nunca lo he creído.

I have never believed it.

Aprender
to learn

→ **aprendido**

He aprendido mucho español.

I have learnt a lot of Spanish.

Oír
to hear

→ **oído**

No te he oído.

I did not hear you.

Seguir
to follow / keep on

→ **seguido**

He seguido tu consejo.

I have followed your advice.

Leer
to read

→ **leído**

He leído dos capítulos.

I have read two chapters.

Pasar
to happen / spend

→ **pasado**

¿Qué ha pasado?

What has happened?

Dejar
to leave / let

→ **dejado**

He dejado las llaves en casa.

I have left the keys at home.

Quedar
to stay / meet up

→ **quedado**

Me he quedado en casa.

I have stayed at home.

Parecer
to seem

→ **parecido**

Me ha parecido bien.

It seemed fine to me.

Deber
must / to owe

→ **debido**

No he debido hacerlo.

I should not have done it.

After *haber* the participle is frozen; after *estar* it agrees. *He roto la pantalla* — who did it. *La pantalla está rota* — the state it is in.

In Spain this is the tense for *hoy, esta semana, este año, ya, todavía no, alguna vez, nunca*. For *ayer* or a finished date, use the *indefinido*.

Pretérito perfecto
Rows 1–4 = the 20 core A1 verbs